

OBSERVERHOTELSYDNEYEDIT

This week we're broadcasting from the historic Rocks area in Sydney, right underneath the Sydney Harbour Bridge, and I have with me as my guest this week at the fabulous Observer Hotel Gavin Andrews, who is the bar manager here at this great pub. Gavin, welcome to the program. Hey, how are you? Now Gavin, tell us about some of the great goings on here.

I know that this is a great destination for people to come to in the Rocks if they're heading to Sydney. Ah, we have live music, it's a fun, upbeat place, lots of different people come in, lots of tourists, famous people. Yes, tell us about some of the famous people who you've seen come through.

We've had Pink, we've had Rob Thomas, David Attenborough, Brian Krauss out of Charmed. Yeah, just quite a few people who, because they love the atmosphere here, and it's a lovely old historic pub, and from where we're sitting here at the front of the hotel, you can have a fabulous view of the Sydney Harbour Bridge. Virtually the whole bridge is there, and it must be just gorgeous.

We're here in the late afternoon, but on a beautiful sunny day, the view is magnificent. Yeah, it's great down here, and I think appeals to most people, yeah. Tell us a bit about the background of the pub.

I believe it was pulled down back in 1901 and then rebuilt, and it's been through a few things of being in such a historic area. It was established in 1848. I used to believe that it was pulled down because of the plague, but then I just read the sign and it said that it was pulled down to Wydon, Middle Lane Street next to it.

Supposedly years ago, when the morgue across the road was full, they used to store the dead bodies down here, and we have our own resident ghost. Yes, tell us about that. What's the ghost story? She's pretty active.

She calls out my name sometimes. She moves things around. We actually had on CCTV footage where the fridge flies open and the steaks come out of the fridge and then shuts again.

Are you kidding? And is there a name to this person? Well, we believe it is a lady that died here in 1948 or something like that, Edna. A partner at the time accidentally shot her. What? And she was staying here in the pub? Supposedly, yeah.

And how does that work? Is it when you're back in the back rooms or something and you hear, go in. Well, what's it like? Well, it just usually sounds like a staff member, but I've always asked the staff member if they've called out to me, and they haven't. Oh, that's a bit creepy.

And I usually do a check upstairs, probably about half an hour before we close, and on a few

occasions, just before I leave, the door upstairs slams, so all the doors and windows are closed. Oh, weird. But that's great.

People love that sort of thing, and hopefully Edna's looking over us now and she's having a quiet drink in the background somewhere. Always nice to her. That's right.

Now, singing is legendary at the Rocks pub. Not for you, I know, but people come here and it must get pretty raucous sometimes when they start singing the songs late at night. No, it's great.

It's a great atmosphere. Everyone gets into it and has a great time. And some of the traditional songs they sing, what are some of those? I believe some of the operas get a go and all sorts of things.

There's always K-San, there's always Brown-Eyed Girl, American Pie, Sweet Home Alabama, and Johnny Cash songs, always. That's great. So people can come down here and just sit here right at the foot of the bridge with a tremendous view, and it must be great at night.

We're here in the, it's not quite dark yet, but at night with all the lights on the bridge, it must be magnificent. That's great. Yeah, it's really good.

And how can people find out more about the Observer Hotel here at the Rocks in Sydney online? You can go to our website on www.observerhotel.com.au. Gavin Andrews, the bar manager here at the Observer Hotel. It's a lovely place. Make sure you come and see him and say hello.

Gavin, thanks for being part of the program. No worries.